

SEO Performance & Recovery Plan

Built on measured Google Search Console clicks. Supersedes all earlier versions, which used Ahrefs estimates.

trocglobal.com August 5, 2026 Measurement window: May 4 – August 2, 2026 (90 days)

Live dashboard: landingstroc.github.io/seo-dashboard — refreshes daily from Search Console and Ahrefs.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Three findings

Clicks / month

1,323

measured, not estimated

Impressions / quarter

1.21M

we are seen constantly

Click-through rate

0.33%

2–5% is normal

Non-branded clicks

16.9%

248 clicks in 90 days

1. The content consolidation worked. It removed 279 pages that were being shown in search results and never clicked. Impressions fell 43%, but clicks fell only 13% — so click-through rate rose by half. This should be reported as a completed win.

2. The real problem is that we are almost never clicked. Google showed trocglobal.com **1.21 million times** last quarter and sent **3,969 visits**. That is a 0.33% click-through rate against a 2–5% norm. Twenty-five pages rank on page one with a CTR below 2%. The traffic problem is not ranking — it is conversion from ranking.

3. Almost all of it is our own name. Of sampled clicks, **83.1% are branded**. In 90 days, just **248 clicks** came from people who did not already know T-ROC.

Why the numbers differ from previous reports

Earlier reports used Ahrefs, which *estimates* traffic from rankings. Search Console *counts* clicks. For this site Ahrefs overstates by **3.8x** — it reported 5,008 monthly visits where Google measured 1,323. Every prior figure sourced from Ahrefs was inflated by roughly that factor, and all targets here have been rebased. Ahrefs remains reliable for rankings, backlinks and Domain Rating; it is not reliable for traffic.

THE QUARTER IN THREE MEASURES

Impressions fell. Clicks held. Efficiency improved.

Weekly, May through August. Three separate scales, so three separate charts — read them together.



Settled: the 271-page consolidation was a success

DAILY AVERAGE	MAY 4 – JUN 29	JUL 14 – AUG 2	CHANGE
Impressions	14,858	8,493	–42.8%
Clicks	46	40	–13.5%
Click-through rate	0.31%	0.47%	+52%

All 489 pruned pages had zero traffic. 279 now redirect cleanly to relevant destinations, none return 404, and no redirect chains exist. Losing impressions from pages that never earned a click is the goal, not a cost.

Correction: an earlier version of this document read the impressions drop as damage. With click data available, that reading was wrong.

AHREFS — RANKINGS, AUTHORITY & BACKLINKS

The ranking engine is working

Ahrefs is the right source for rankings, Domain Rating and backlinks. Every one of these improved over the quarter — which is precisely why the click problem matters: **we are winning positions and not converting them.**

Domain Rating

43

+1 vs. June

Ranking keywords

429

+5.4% vs. June

Keywords in Top 3

191

+11.0% vs. June

Referring domains

3,267

+6.6% — see caveat

Live backlinks

14,930

+25.9% — see caveat

Ahrefs traffic *estimate*

5,008

3.8× the measured figure

Two-month movement · June 5 → August 5, 2026

AHREFS KPI	JUN 5	JUL 5	AUG 5	JUN → AUG
Live backlinks	11,858	13,677	14,930	+25.9%
Keywords in Top 3	172	235	191	+11.0%
Referring domains	3,065	3,234	3,267	+6.6%
Ranking keywords	407	519	429	+5.4%
Domain Rating	42	43	43	+1
<i>Organic traffic (estimate)</i>	4,785	3,290	5,008	not used for targets

The July spike is the clearest evidence we have

In July, Ahrefs recorded the site's **highest-ever ranking counts — 519 keywords and 235 in the Top 3**. Search Console recorded that same month's **lowest click-through rate of the quarter (0.23%)**. More top rankings, fewer clicks per impression. Rankings are not the constraint.

Do not report the backlink growth as a win

Backlinks rose 25.9% in two months, but the growth is not earned. An external spam network is generating links using domains built to mimic ours — **84% of inbound link text is spam**, advertising an SEO reseller. Referring-domain and backlink counts are inflated by it, and filing a disavow is a cleanup item in Phase 4, not a growth lever.

THE CORE PROBLEM

Seen a million times, clicked four thousand

These pages rank on **page one** and are shown tens of thousands of times each quarter, yet return almost nothing. A position-5 result normally earns around 5%.

PAGE	AVG. POSITION	IMPRESSIONS	CLICKS	CTR
/experiential-retail-pop-up-events/	5.5	81,013	38	0.05%
/retail-automation-distribution-centers-walmart/	6.4	36,608	95	0.26%
/different-types-of-brand-ambassadors-2/	9.2	30,921	135	0.44%
/luxury-pop-up-stores-shipping-containers/	5.2	28,742	23	0.08%
/automated-retail-trends-arki-insights/	8.6	26,702	13	0.05%
/retail-revenue-optimization-strategies...	6.2	18,010	2	0.01%

25 pages hold a top-10 position with CTR under 2% — ten to a hundred times below expectation. Those six alone drew **221,000 impressions and 349 clicks**.

The size of the prize — and what we do not yet know

At an ordinary 3% CTR, those six pages would return roughly **6,900 clicks** instead of 349. Site-wide, 1.21M impressions at a modest 2% would mean **~24,000 clicks a quarter** against today's 3,969.

That is the scale of the opportunity, not a forecast. **We have one verified cause and two unverified ones.** Broken titles are confirmed (below). But 0.05% at position 5 is too extreme for titles alone — the other candidates are queries where our page is not what the searcher wanted, and AI Overviews answering before the click. Separating them needs a per-page query breakdown, which is the first task in Phase 1.

VERIFIED CAUSE

The page titles are broken

The system generating our titles **truncates them at 50 characters**, then appends

- T-ROC . What a searcher sees:

PAGE HEADING	TITLE SHOWN IN GOOGLE
Understanding Merchandising Inventory: A Comprehensive Guide	Understanding Merchandising Inventory: A - T-ROC
The Importance of Retail Merchandising: Maximizing Sales and Delighting Customers	The Importance of Retail Merchandising: Maximizing - T-ROC

Measured across the 61 pages that rank:

DEFECT	PAGES	EFFECT
Title cut off mid-sentence	12	Reads as broken at the moment of the click decision
Title tag completely empty	3	Google invents one; we lose control of the message
Brand duplicated T-ROC - T-ROC	2	78 characters, truncated on screen
No H1 heading	8	Google cannot identify the page's topic

WHERE GROWTH ACTUALLY IS

Two commercial terms are stuck at the bottom of page one

Our highest-value non-branded searches are already earning thousands of impressions — at positions just low enough to earn nothing:

SEARCH TERM	IMPRESSIONS	POSITION	CLICKS	CTR
brand ambassador	3,755	10.8	9	0.24%
retail merchandising services	3,735	10.5	7	0.19%
automated retail machine	330	9.2	11	3.33%
brand ambassador programs	230	25.5	5	2.17%

Position **10.5** is the bottom of page one — visible, almost never clicked. Moving these two terms into the top five is the single clearest growth lever on the site, and both point at pages we already own.

Note the contrast: *automated retail machine* at position 9.2 converts at 3.33%, while our top-5 pages convert at 0.05%. Position alone does not explain the gap — which is why the query breakdown matters.

BRAND DEPENDENCE

83% of clicks come from people who already know us

TOP SEARCH TERMS BY CLICKS	CLICKS	IMPRESSIONS	CTR	TYPE
troc	413	5,636	7.33%	Brand
t-roc	217	1,546	14.04%	Brand
troc global	199	500	39.80%	Brand
t roc	92	1,986	4.63%	Brand
brand ambassador	9	3,755	0.24%	Non-brand
retail merchandising services	7	3,735	0.19%	Non-brand

Branded searches convert at **7–40%**. Non-branded searches with comparable impressions convert at **0.2%**. The business is visible to people looking for T-ROC by name and effectively invisible to everyone else.

A previously used dashboard reported "100% non-branded — strong organic discovery" while holding zero click data. The measured figure is **83.1% branded**. That panel should not be used.

SEARCH CONSOLE — INDEX COVERAGE

Only 39.6% of the site is in Google

Of **1,751 known pages**, Google has indexed **694**. A page that is not indexed cannot rank, cannot be seen and cannot be clicked — it is invisible regardless of how good it is.

Indexed

694

39.6% of known pages

Not indexed

1,057

60.4%

Peak indexed

821

Jun 12–29, before the prune

Validation failing

379

redirect pages

REASON NOT INDEXED	PAGES	SHARE	READING
Crawled – currently not indexed	465	44.0%	Google crawled these and <i>chose</i> not to index them. A content-quality judgement, not a technical fault — and the largest single bucket.
Page with redirect validation failed	379	35.9%	Expected. These are the consolidation's 301s. Redirected URLs are meant to leave the index — this is the cleanup showing up, not damage.
Not found (404)	90	8.5%	Source unidentified. All 489 pruned URLs were checked and none return 404, so these come from somewhere else.
Excluded by "noindex" tag	64	6.1%	Intentional if correct — worth auditing that each one should be excluded.
Duplicate — Google chose a different canonical	21	2.0%	Google disagreed with our canonical. Signals near-duplicate content.
Discovered – currently not indexed	29	2.7%	Known but not yet crawled. Crawl-budget pressure.
Alternate page with proper canonical	6	0.6%	Normal.

REASON NOT INDEXED	PAGES	SHARE	READING
Blocked by robots.txt / 4xx / 5xx	3	0.3%	Negligible, but each is a hard block.

The 465 are the number that matters

"Crawled – currently not indexed" means Google looked and declined. The most likely feeder is the **210 zero-traffic pages still live** from the consolidation — the job is only 57% complete, and those pages continue consuming crawl budget while adding nothing. Finishing the prune is the direct treatment.

The **90 404s** need separate investigation: they are not from the prune list, which was verified clean.

Source and limitation: these figures come from a Search Console coverage export covering data to July 23, 2026. Unlike clicks and impressions, **index coverage is not available through the Search Console API** — Google only exposes it in the interface. It therefore cannot be added to the live dashboard and must be re-exported manually to refresh.

DIAGNOSIS

Root causes, graded by evidence

CAUSE	EVIDENCE	SEVERITY
Click-through collapse 0.33% site-wide; 25 top-10 pages under 2%	Measured	Critical
Broken page titles 12 truncated, 3 empty, 2 duplicated brand	Verified on the live site	Critical
Brand dependence 248 non-branded clicks in 90 days	Measured	Critical
Cloudflare blocking crawlers Site returns "you have been blocked"	Reproduced Aug 5	High

CAUSE	EVIDENCE	SEVERITY
H1 fix never deployed Code written July 15, still inactive	Verified	High
Consolidation only 57% complete 210 of 489 flagged pages still live	Checked all 489 URLs	High
60% of pages not indexed 465 crawled and declined; 90 unexplained 404s	Search Console coverage	High
Query-intent mismatch / AI Overviews Suspected additional cause of the CTR gap	Unverified	To investigate

ROADMAP

Four phases

Reordered around measured evidence. Click-through rate is now the primary metric: it is measured weekly, it moves fast, and it is the binding constraint on every other number.

PHASE 1 Fix the click-through rate

Highest return

Weeks 1–3

- **Run the per-page query breakdown first.** For the 25 low-CTR pages, identify which searches drive their impressions. This separates a title problem from an intent mismatch and decides whether we rewrite or retarget. *No effort should be committed before this.*
- **Repair the title system** — remove the 50-character truncation and the duplicated brand suffix.
- **Rewrite the 12 truncated and 3 empty titles**, each carrying its target search term.
- **Activate the H1 fix** in WPCode — written since July 15, five minutes to deploy.
- Measure weekly. CTR responds within days of re-crawl, so this validates or disproves itself quickly.

PHASE 2 Convert the two head terms

Weeks 2–5

- **"brand ambassador"** — 3,755 impressions at position 10.8. Consolidate the ~12 competing articles into the service page so one strong page ranks instead of a dozen weak ones.
- **"retail merchandising services"** — 3,735 impressions at position 10.5, pointing at a money page.

- Internal links from the highest-authority pages to both targets.
- Moving either from position 10 to position 3–5 changes them from ~8 clicks a quarter to several hundred.

PHASE 3 Finish the cleanup and unblock crawling

Weeks 1–6

- **Cloudflare / WP Engine:** allow Googlebot, Bingbot and AhrefsBot. *Requires the infrastructure administrator.*
- **Complete the consolidation** — 210 of 489 flagged zero-traffic pages are still live and still being crawled.
- **Attack the 465 "crawled, not indexed"** — the largest not-indexed bucket. Finishing the prune is the direct treatment; anything remaining after that is a content-quality problem needing consolidation or improvement, not more pages.
- **Trace the 90 404s.** They are not from the prune list, so the source is unknown — likely broken internal links or stale external references.
- Audit the 64 `noindex` pages and the 21 where Google overrode our canonical.
- **Target: indexation rate from 39.6% back above 55%.**

PHASE 4 Break the brand dependence

Weeks 4–12

- Build on whatever Phase 1 proves: if titles drive the CTR gap, apply the fix site-wide; if intent mismatch does, retarget the affected pages.
- **Optimise for AI answers** — the definitional queries losing clicks are exactly what AI Overviews absorb.
- File the disavow for the spam link network. *Hygiene, not growth — Google already discounts most of it.*
- **Target: non-branded click share from 16.9% to 30%.**

OBJECTIVES

90-day targets · November 5, 2026

METRIC	TODAY	TARGET	VIA
Click-through rate	0.33%	0.70%	Phase 1 — the core lever

METRIC	TODAY	TARGET	VIA
Clicks / month	1,323	2,600	Phases 1–2
Non-branded click share	16.9%	30%	Phases 2 & 4
Top-10 pages with CTR under 2%	25	under 10	Phase 1
"brand ambassador" position	10.8	top 5	Phase 2
Indexation rate	39.6%	55%+	Phase 3
Keywords in Top 3 (Ahrefs)	191	240	Phases 2–3
Ranking keywords (Ahrefs)	429	500	Phases 2–3
Domain Rating (Ahrefs)	43	43–45	Not forced

Every target except Domain Rating is measured in Search Console and verifiable weekly. Doubling CTR to 0.70% still leaves the site well below a normal 2% — this is deliberately conservative.

REQUIREMENTS

What's needed to execute

ITEM	NEEDED FOR	STATUS
Google Search Console	Measured clicks — now feeding the live dashboard daily	Done
WPCode on production	Title system and H1 fix — <i>blocks Phase 1</i>	Blocked
WP Engine / Cloudflare admin	Unblock Google's crawlers	Blocked
Decision on the brand-ambassador cluster	Which of ~12 articles to merge or retire	Needs sign-off

The one thing holding up the highest-return work

Phase 1 needs WPCode access on production. Editing the SEO plugin fields directly will not hold — an override snippet overwrites them. Without that access the corrected titles can only be delivered as a specification for someone else to apply.

Measurement. Click, impression, CTR and position figures come from the Google Search Console API for the property <https://trocgloba1.com/> , May 4 – August 2, 2026. Search Console data lags 2–3 days by Google's design. The property is URL-prefix, so it excludes jobs.trocgloba1.com .

On Ahrefs. Ahrefs figures appear only for rankings, backlinks and Domain Rating. Its traffic estimates overstate measured clicks by 3.8× for this site and are not used for any target here. Its keyword coverage is the top 100 by traffic; the plan in use ignores pagination, so the long tail is unmeasured.

Branded classification is by explicit pattern match on T-ROC's names. Ahrefs' automatic flag is unreliable for this domain — it marks "walmart wallpaper" as branded and "troc" as not.

Prepared August 5, 2026 · Measured Search Console data, Ahrefs API v3, and direct inspection of 61 ranking pages and 489 pruned URLs.